INTRODUCTION

Food is vital for sustenance of life for all organisms. However, the billions and trillions of cells in our body cannot utilize the complex constituents present in the food we eat like lip smacking pizzas or burgers and idlies or dosas, directly. Hence, these complex molecules should be broken down into simpler forms for the cells to assimilate and use them. The process by which the complex food is broken down mechanically (i.e. physically, in mouth and stomach), as well as chemically to smaller macromolecules that can be utilized by the cells of our body is called as digestion. Digestion is unique to heterotrophs, as autotrophs like plants are capable of synthesizing their own food. The process of conversion of food to fuel that could be used by cells is aided by the digestive system and it is a unique anatomical feature of the animal kingdom.

2.1 DIGESTIVE SYSTEM:

The digestive system is made up of a tubular gastro -intestinal tract (GI tract), extending from mouth till anus, and secretory organs (Figure 2.1). The organs of the GI tract include the oral cavity, pharynx, stomach, small intestine, large intestine, rectum and anus. The accessory digestive organs include the salivary glands, oxyntic and parietal glands of the stomach, duodenal glands, liver, gall bladder and pancreas.

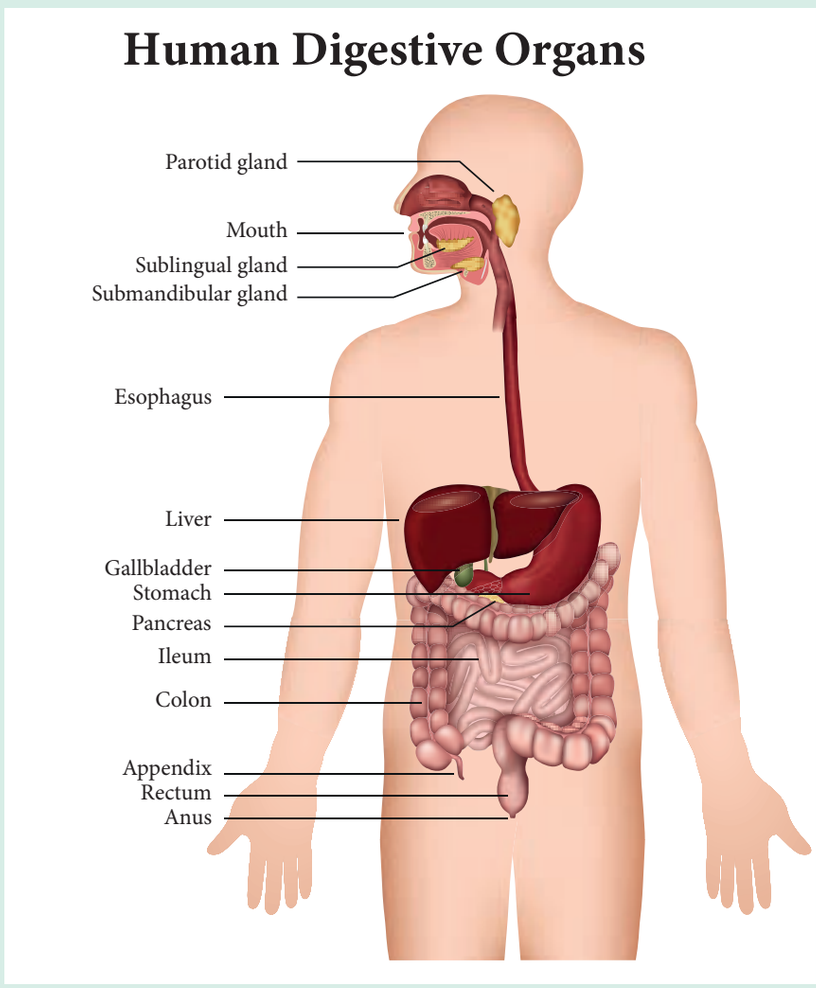


Figure 2.1 Digestive system of human

2.1.1 Gastrointestinal Tract:

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